NICOL LEÓN ARGE

BILINGUAL REPORTER (ENGLISH/SPANISH)

WHO AM I?

Bilingual (English–Spanish) journalist with experience reporting and producing human rights and immigration stories. Skilled in reporting stories for broad audiences, with a focus on making complex issues accessible. Experienced working across newsrooms and collaborative projects to amplify underreported stories through editorial, audience engagement and multimedia formats.

SKILLS

Fact-checking
Document-based reporting (court records, public filings)
Social media newsgathering and audience engagement
FOIA/FOIL requests and public records retrieval
PACER, CourtListener, LexisNexis
Data cleaning, analysis and visualization
Working closely with reporters and editors under deadlines

EDUCATION

Craig Newmark Graduate School of Journalism at CUNY — New York, NY / M.A. in Bilingual Journalism, 2025

Universidad Nacional Federico Villarreal — Lima, Perú / B.A. in Communication Sciences (Journalism specialization), 2018

RECOGNITION

Lorana Sullivan Scholar, CUNY, 2024
Newsweek Alumni Prize - 2026 Alumni Awards for Excellence
NAHJ-FIU Chapter, Second Place, 2025

CONTACT DETAILS

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LinkedIn profile

JOURNALISM EXPERIENCE

Latino Communities and Local News Reporter
Tri-City Herald, McClatchy Media (Tri-Cities, WA) | 2026

- Report on Latino communities and local issues in the Tri-Cities region of Eastern Washington.

Freelance Reporter
The New York Times (New York, NY) | 2026

- Reported on a deadly explosion at a Staten Island shipyard, interviewing witnesses and residents on the scene and covering emergency response efforts and community impact

Freelance Reporter
Documented NY (New York, NY) | December2025-April2026

- Pitched and reported fast-turn immigration coverage capturing Venezuelan asylum seekers' reactions to Nicolás Maduro's capture, delivering publish-ready copy on a one-day deadline in a rapidly evolving news cycle.
- Reported on gaps in access to city-funded legal services by interviewing asylum seekers and community organizations, documenting how policy decisions impact day-to-day life and access to resources.

Reporter Intern
WNYC Radio / Gothamist (New York, NY) | October–December 2025

- Helped break a major story on eviction notices at the Row Hotel migrant shelter by identifying resident tips, verifying documents with city agencies and reporting from the field.
- Adapted reporting for radio scripts and broadcast production, collaborating with editors to shape stories for audio audiences.

Immigration Reporter Intern
The Arizona Republic / Gannett (Phoenix, AZ) | Jun–Aug 2025

- Pitched, reported and wrote 12 stories in English and Spanish for digital publication, covering breaking and enterprise developments on immigration and public policy.
- Produced fast, accurate copy from court filings, public records, interviews and field reporting under tight newsroom deadlines.
- Observed immigration hearings, reviewed federal filings and interviewed advocates to build clear, timely stories on complex legal issues.
- Analyzed a non-public dataset to identify migration trends and support original reporting.

Reporter
Puente News Collaborative & CUNY (El Paso, TX) | Apr–Jun 2025

- Selected for a U.S.-Mexico border reporting collaboration focused on immigration and federal policy.
- Reported and produced an enterprise story on reunification barriers for unaccompanied immigrant minors through interviews, court observation and federal data analysis.
- Led the creation of a Datawrapper visualization that translated public data into a clear, accessible visual story element.

Freelance Reporter
El País US & El País América | 2024–2025

- Reported on the closure of NYC emergency shelter hotels by interviewing immigrant mothers and advocates, documenting housing insecurity and the on-the-ground impacts of policy decisions.

Reporter
NYC News Service & El Deadline (CUNY) | 2024

- Followed up on a class-action lawsuit against a Bronx landlord over post-fire conditions, uncovering the company's failure to comply with a Bronx Civil Court order; conducted on-site reporting and visual documentation of building hazards, reviewed court filings and appendices detailing fire damage, and interviewed tenants and their attorney.

Reporter
La República, Infobae, Wayka | Lima, Perú | 2019 - 2023

- Reported on politics, human rights, and local accountability in Peru using public records, producing investigations on delays in child sexual assault cases, labor abuses involving Peru Rail (owned by Lima's former mayor), domestic violence allegations against a far-right congressional candidate.